CalWORKs Program Guide: A. Property

COUNTY OF SAN DIEGO HEALTH & HUMAN SERVICES AGENCY - CALWORKS PROGRAM GUIDE

Effective Revision Date: 2026-01-01

Section 1

COUNTY OF SAN DIEGO HEALTH AND HUMAN SERVICES AGENCY
CALWORKS PROGRAM GUIDE ? SECTION 42-200: PROPERTY LIMITS
TITLE: A. PROPERTY LIMITATIONS AND RESOURCE DETERMINATION

Section 2

1. POLICY BACKGROUND & PURPOSE
This section establishes allowable personal and real property limits for CalWORKs eligibility in San Diego County in accordance with California Welfare and Institutions Code Section 11257 and CDSS MPP EAS 42-200. CalWORKs maintains statutory property limitations to ensure cash aid is directed to families with limited liquid and non-liquid resources.

Section 3

2. DETAILED REGULATORY STANDARDS & PROPERTY LIMITS
? Property Limit Thresholds: The total countable personal and real property reserve of an assistance unit cannot exceed:
(1) $11,634 for standard households; or
(2) $17,451 for assistance units that include at least one member who is 60 years of age or older, or disabled.
? Motor Vehicle Valuation Exemption: Effective under current state statute, each licensed motor vehicle with an equity value up to the statutory limit ($32,045) is exempt. Additional family work vehicles or vehicles used to transport a disabled family member are fully exempt.
? Real Property Exemption: The primary home owned and occupied by the assistance unit is completely exempt regardless of its market or assessed value.
? Countable Property Categories: Countable assets include checking and savings account balances, non-exempt second vehicles, stocks, bonds, cryptocurrency, non-resident real estate, and recreational watercraft.
? Excluded Resources: Household goods, personal effects, clothing, tools of a trade necessary for employment, student financial aid savings, and retirement accounts (401k, IRA, pensions) are fully exempt.

Section 4

3. CASEWORKER OPERATING PROCEDURES & VERIFICATION CHECKLIST

? Asset Evaluation at Intake & Redetermination: Review bank accounts, vehicle registrations, and property ownership declared on the SAWS 2 Plus.

? Excess Property Spending: If property exceeds the limit, the customer has the legal right to spend down excess resources on legitimate living expenses or debt payment prior to the date of granting.

? Electronic Verification: Utilize automated DMV and asset verification queries to confirm vehicle ownership and bank balances before issuing adverse actions.